

Note Mode

– A Canvas Intervention –

Bea Luna

How Might We...

...help students using Canvas retain knowledge and stay focused while reading across mobile and desktop clients?



Persona: Valarie Anderson

About:

- 20 y/o, female
- 2nd year business and design major
- Likes to draw, paint, crochet, knitting, listening to music
- Chronically online, active on social media



Persona: Valarie Anderson

User Frustrations:

- Only reads for school
 - Wants to do better on her reading assignments
 - Finds the subject boring and struggles to focus on anything that doesn't interest her
- Doesn't have any note-taking strategies when doing her readings
 - Tends to forget the things she reads once finishing.
- Social media is more enticing than her educational readings
 - Her friends keep sending her TikToks



What Are They Doing? Why?

Goal: Research for an essay on modern design practices.

Task: Read and take notes on Hara.pdf for your class Design Process and Practices.

Why Use Note Mode?

- Reading PDFs on Canvas (desktop) can be tedious
 - Students usually have another note-taking app open in adjacent to Canvas
 - Switching back and forth can increase chances of distraction
 - Less engaging experience, less retention of information
- Note Mode aims to improve the reading experience on Canvas
 - Highlight and write about quotes
 - Pause and reflect prompts
 - My Files tab

How?

Features of Note Mode

- **Highlight quotes from the text in the pdf and quickly summarize takeaways**
 - Helps stay organized and avoid distractions.
 - Note Mode delegates all activity relating to reading/note-taking to one place
- **Pause and reflect prompts: A physical break in a document prompts the user to answer a question on what they just read**
 - Increases retention by summarizing bits of information at a time.
 - Stay engaged with what you're reading
- **My Files tab: Centralizes and saves all notes automatically**
 - Keep notes organized and in one place for easy access

How?

Goal: Research for an essay on modern design practices.

Task: Read and take notes on Hara.pdf for your class Design Process and Practices.

Prototype link:

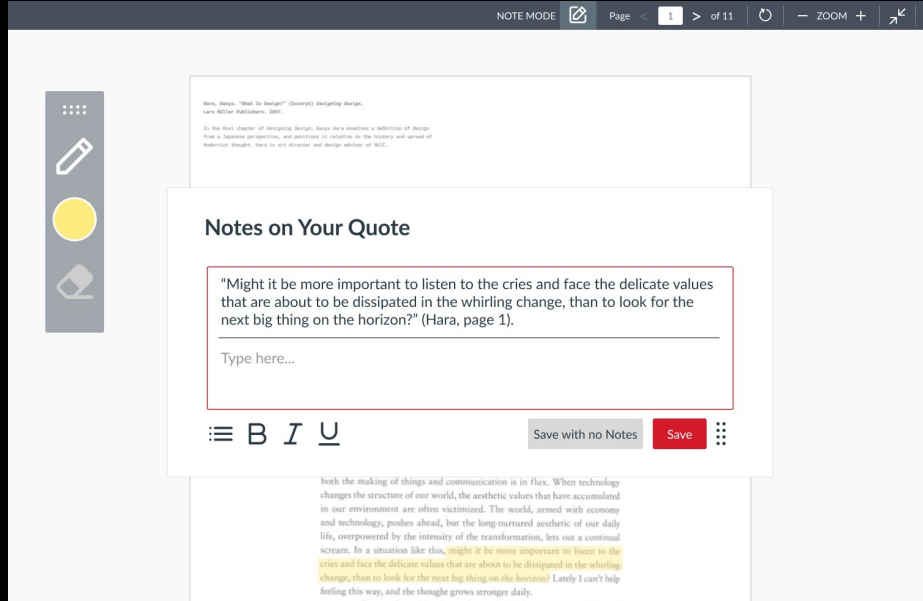
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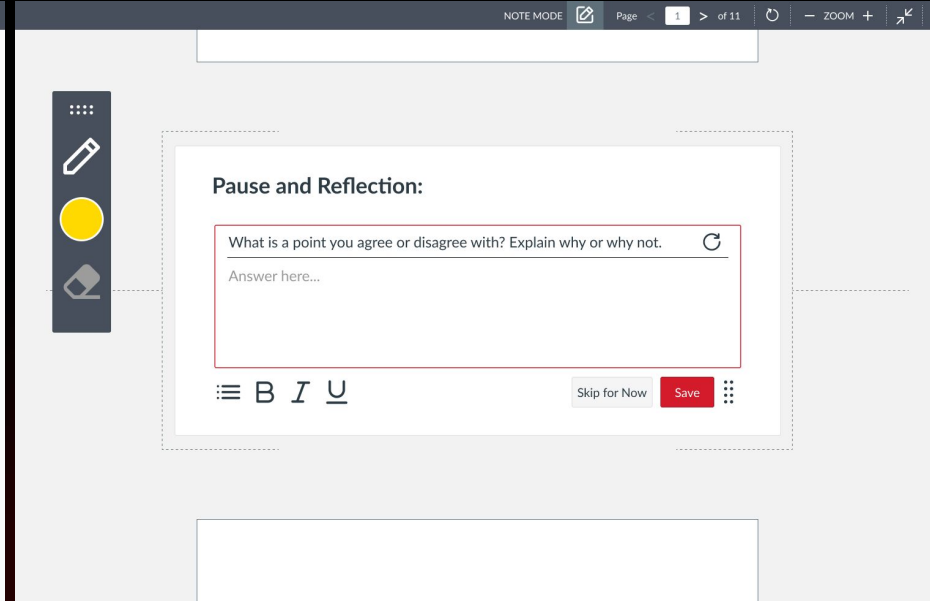
Taskflow

1. **Valarie opens the Canvas Dashboard**
2. **Selects Design Process and Practices card**
3. **Navigates to Hara.pdf in the Modules**
4. **Turns on Note Mode**
5. **Highlights a quote and writes a quick note about its significance**
6. **Every two pages, pauses to reflect using the prompted questions.**
7. **Reaches the end of the document**
8. **Views compiled notes in My Files tab**

Screen Overview – Computer

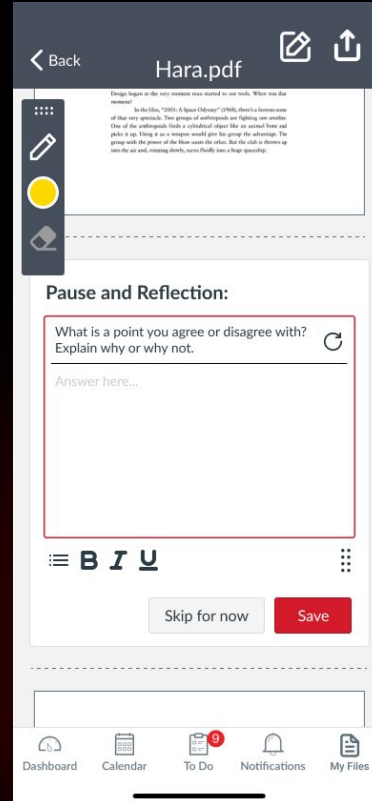
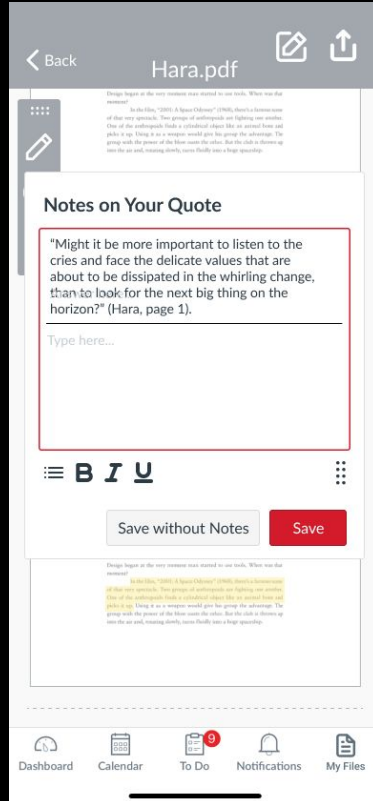


Notes on Your Quote appears after highlighting a quote



Reflection Prompt appears every two pages

Screen Overview – Phone



Thank You!